12. ‘Ayodhya banegi vaishwik nagari’, *Dainik Jagran* (Fatehpur edition), 14 November 2020, p.1; ‘Gaurav-bodh se alokit huee Ram nagari’, *Dainik Jagran* (Fatehpur edition), 14 November 2020, p. 3.
13. The UP government, under Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, renamed Allahabad as Prayagraj on 16 October 2018. The change was ratified by the Union government on 1 January 2019, a day before the Kumbh Mela. The chief minister justified the name-change saying, ‘Five hundred years ago the name of the place was Prayagraj as it is at the “Triveni Sangam” (a confluence of three rivers) … There are many Prayags on the bank of the sacred rivers coming from the Himalayas but this place is Prayagraj [King of Prayags].’ PTI, ‘UP cabinet approves renaming of Allahabad to Prayagraj’, *The Economic Times*, 17 October 2018, https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/uttar-pradesh-cabinet-renames-allahbad-to-prayagraj/articleshow/66234532.cms; Rahul Tripathi, ‘Days before Kumbh Mela, Centre approves renaming of Allahabad as Prayagraj’, *The Indian Express*, 2 January 2019, https://indianexpress.com/article/india/home-ministry-allahabad-prayagraj-kumbh-mela-5518766/.
14. Regional Tourism Offices data from the UP government, ‘The Indian and foreign tourist visits in important tourist places of Uttar Pradesh in year 2015 to 2019’, 12 February 2020, internal note by UP government. Similar data, along the same trendline, was also presented by the state government at the UP Investors Summit, 2018. UP Government PPT presentation at UP Investors Summit, 21–22 February 2018, *UP Nahi Dekha to India Nahi Dekha*. I am grateful to Pravin Kumar for providing a copy of this 2018 government presentation and the 2020 data note.
15. UP state budgets, year-wise, available at: http://budget.up.nic.in/. Figures on Yogi Adityanath’s first state budget from Anuja Jaiswal, ‘Prayagraj, Ayodhya & Vrindavan see rush of domestic tourists’, *The Times of India*, 25 April 2019.
16. The National High Speed Rail Corporation Limited (NHRSCL) was working on detailed project reports (DPR) for seven new high-speed rail corridors: 1. Delhi–Varanasi (865 km) 2. Delhi–